



Photorealistic kid drawings

This dad of 2 converts drawings by his kids into photorealistic images, with horrifying results
<https://dgit.in/sep18-81-1>



How to prevent a robot uprising

Is it possible to stop a robot uprising by teaching empathy to the armies of AI bots that we are going to create? <https://dgit.in/sep18-81-2>

exercise enough to reduce weight, but does that change the reasoning of the argument that exercising does reduce weight for real?

In tech, however, the fallacy is often more me quoque than tu quoque. For example, when Apple launched the iPhone X (pronounced “ten” not “ex”), some people loved the notch, and some hated it. (We still hate it). However, as you can see from the market today, a lot of manufacturers have jumped on to the bandwagon and are offering a similar looking display. Why? Because they assume that the iPhone has established itself as a product that’s high end and good quality, so mimicking it (me too) rubs off some of that goodwill on to their product as well. Of course they will never admit to that, and we hear all sorts of excuses for why a notch is actually better, or how it just increases the screen to bezel ratio (which is just another marketing gimmick, honestly), but we have to point out that had it been a cheap Chinese brand that had done it, no one would rush to copy it, would they?

SUNK COST

This is a fallacy whereby you fool yourself into valuing the investment you have put into something as opposed to future gains. This is most common for, say, careers, where someone who has put in a decade of work into one career, sticks to it despite job shortages, no growth and no job security, because they place a value on the work and effort they have put in the past, and think that it is just as valuable as future growth.

In technology, this is usually something you do to yourself, but it is also done to you by very smart marketeers. Many companies try and invent an entire ecosystem around their products to get you so invested that you cannot ever consider leaving them. Apple is notorious for this, but is far from the only company attempting to do

this. They just happen to be the most successful, where your chargers are useless for any other brand’s devices, or your connectors. Although Google may be considered as a company that does not do this, it in fact is trying to, using the Google assistant, Google Home, Maps, etc, to try and ensure you’re invested in their ecosystem.

This is not going to change, of course, and every company is entitled



A CASE OF TU QUOQUE.

She. “HOW DO YOU LIKE MY NEW HAT?”
 Sutherland Highlander. “BY JOVE, WHAT EXTRAORDINARY HEADGEAR
 YOU WOMEN DO WEAR!”

A comic from Punch magazine

to try and offer you amazing products to try and trap you in their system, but it’s important that you realise that the attempt is to get you to sink costs, so that you can fool yourself with the sunk costs fallacy later (in case you ever want a change).

FALSE DICHOTOMY

Although mainly used by politicians in the past, this fallacy is being used increasingly by everyday people who seem to think more in terms of binary than anything else. Examples

you might have come across are: “If you don’t love me you must hate me”, which is obviously not the case, because we neither love nor hate 99.9999999% of people on the planet! “If you love Android you must hate iOS”. “If you use Windows, you are against Open Source software” etc.

Rarely, a dichotomy is actually all there is, for example, AMD and NVIDIA when it comes to graphics cards, but you can still find the false dichotomy there as well: “NVIDIA has the fastest card, so all AMD cards are inferior”, which is obviously untrue, because for a given budget, often either NVIDIA or AMD cards are the better buy on performance to price ratios.

The “if you’re not with us, then you’re against us” false dichotomy is perhaps the most common one found online now. In terms of technology, these are most often used by fanboys on forums or in discussions, and you should be quick to point them out when they’re thrown at you. To quote Obi Wan Kenobi, “Only a Sith deals in absolutes!”. Oh wait, that’s a false dichotomy as well... never mind...

LET’S BE SMARTER

There are several dozens of fallacies that have been identified, and they are used by us and against us on a daily basis. The aim of this article was to get you to start thinking about these fallacies, and even others that we have not mentioned here because of space constraints. Once you recognise how to spot a fallacy, you are far less likely to ever be fooled by it, and that, after all is our job – to prevent you from being fooled as consumers. **A**

Editor’s footnote: We are sure we’ve missed a lot of fallacies here and how they are applied in the tech world, especially in ads. So can you point them out to us? Write in and let us know, and we will publish the best answers in upcoming issues.